Protecting Every Citizen's Vote

GS II

- Electoral rolls contain the names of people eligible to vote. Over time, deaths, migration and other changes can make these lists inaccurate. Regular revision is therefore necessary to maintain **accurate electoral rolls** and protect the fairness of elections.

- However, during voter list revision, genuine voters may be removed if officials wrongly identify them as ineligible or fail to verify their details properly. Such **wrongful deletions** can prevent citizens from exercising their democratic rights.

- The problem becomes more serious when affected voters are not given adequate notice, an opportunity to explain their eligibility or a fair process to challenge removal. Without **due process**, an administrative exercise can result in voter exclusion.

- The Election Commission must therefore combine accurate voter verification with transparency, accountability and effective **grievance redressal**. Electoral roll revision strengthens democracy only when errors can be corrected and eligible citizens are protected from wrongful exclusion.

Accurate electoral rolls protect election integrity, but revisions must follow fair procedures so that removing ineligible entries does not deny genuine voters their democratic rights.